

Loud Voters — Design Brief 05/05

Date: May 5, 2026 **From:** Meeting with Jay, Dhruv, Chris

What changed

Six decisions came out of today's call with David. These are the priorities for the next design iteration — focus on structure and hierarchy, not visual polish.

1. Remove support/oppose buttons from bill cards

David's directive: users can't meaningfully support or oppose a bill they haven't read yet. Kill the dual buttons on the card. The card should drive users *into* the bill first — the vote action happens after they've read it. We still need a clear call-to-action on the card, but it should be a single entry point, not a binary choice.

2. Bill card = container for everything

The bill is the atom. Each bill card should contain: the bill itself, related news stories, related campaigns, and the progress tracker. Think of it as a mini-dashboard per bill. News and campaigns that currently live separately should collapse into the bill card. This likely means cards get bigger — possibly full-width if we drop the sidebar.

3. Drop the news sidebar → go full-width

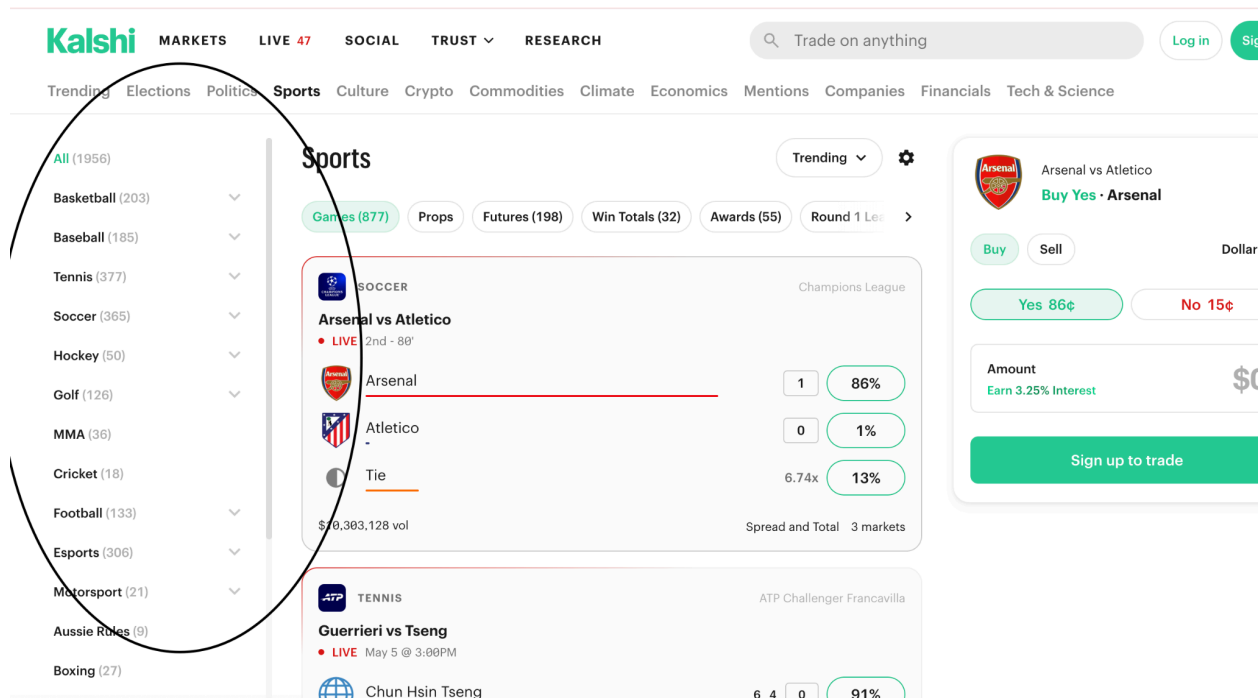
If news gets absorbed into bill cards, the right sidebar isn't needed on day one. Propose a full-width layout for the main feed. The sidebar space gets reclaimed by the cards themselves.

4. Make card types visually distinct

David's feedback: bills, polls, and campaigns look too similar when scrolling. His suggestion was different background colors for campaigns. Could also be size differences, icons, patterns, or shapes — just solve the problem without turning it into a Crayola site. The visual identity of a "campaign" card should be consistent everywhere it appears (standalone and nested inside a bill card).

5. Add trending subcategories on the left

Reference: Kalshi's site (subcategory sidebar visible when you're in a category). We want this on the trending page too. A user interested in "Iran" should see that keyword immediately, not have to scroll the whole feed. Pull subcategory labels from the top trending bills' tags/issues.



6. Move location toggle (Texas/National) to the navbar

It currently lives in the sidebar but controls the entire page — that's a hierarchy mismatch. It belongs in the nav alongside the category tabs. The rep info (Federal/State Representatives, View All) still needs a home — TBD, but not where it currently sits. Especially important for logged-in users who see their own rep dashboard.

Color issue (pre-launch fix needed)

The LV brand green and the "support" green are too close. Creates a mixed metaphor. Not prescribing a solution yet — maybe a darker support green, maybe support becomes a different color entirely. But it needs to be resolved before launch.

Feed ranking logic

Ranking = **trending** × **urgency**. Bills in committee should surface highest. Urgency alone would miss trending topics; trending alone would miss time-sensitive votes. We may manually curate or use an LLM to rank the top ~40 bills daily at first.

Priority order

1. Information hierarchy and card structure (bill as container)
2. Card type differentiation
3. Subcategory navigation
4. Nav/location restructuring
5. Color resolution
6. Visual polish (later)